# Accession Progress Index

How far ten candidate countries have come on the road to EU membership, scored from 0 to 100 with a public methodology.

**Preview edition · October 2026**

**75.5** / 100
**HIGHEST FORMAL-STAGE SCORE**
Montenegro, 21 of 33 chapters provisionally closed

**61.2** / 100
**HIGHEST PREPARATION SCORE**
Montenegro, based on Commission ratings

**4 Nov**
**EDITION 1**
Date tied to the Commission's 2026 enlargement package: if the package moves, Edition 1 moves with it

## Key findings

- **Montenegro leads on both measures.** It has opened all 33 chapters and provisionally closed 21, and it has the highest average preparation rating.
- **Albania is second on formal stage (54.8)** after closing its first four chapters in 2026, but Serbia (52.6) and North Macedonia (52.6) are better prepared on paper.
- **Serbia and North Macedonia show the widest gap between preparation and formal progress.** Serbia's Cluster 3 is blocked in the Council; North Macedonia has opened no chapters pending a constitutional amendment.
- **Ukraine and Moldova share the same formal score (43.2)** with four of six clusters open, but have the lowest preparation ratings among countries in negotiations.
- **Türkiye and Georgia are flagged.** Their processes are frozen or halted, so their scores describe past progress rather than current movement.

This preview publishes pillars A and B. Pillar C (reform momentum) and the overall index follow in Edition 1. Independent publication built from public sources; not affiliated with the institutions of the European Union.

## Scores by country

Countries ranked by pillar A. Pillar A (40% of the final index) measures the formal stage of the accession procedure. Pillar B (45%) measures the average level of preparation rated by the European Commission. Pillar C (15%) and the overall index will be published in Edition 1.

| # | COUNTRY AND STAGE | A. FORMAL STAGE | B. PREPARATION | INDEX |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Montenegro**<br>Closing chapters | 75.5 | 61.2 | Edition 1 |
| 2 | **Albania**<br>Closing chapters | 54.8 | 47.7 | Edition 1 |
| 3 | **Serbia**<br>Negotiating, Cluster 3 blocked | 43.5 | 52.6 | Edition 1 |
| 4 | **Moldova**<br>Negotiating, 4 of 6 clusters open | 43.2 | 34.2 | Edition 1 |
| 5 | **Ukraine**<br>Negotiating, 4 of 6 clusters open | 43.2 | 32.9 | Edition 1 |
| 6 | **Türkiye**<br>Negotiations frozen<br>Frozen or halted: scores reflect past progress | 38.3 | 48.4 | Edition 1 |
| 7 | **North Macedonia**<br>Talks launched, no chapters open | 25.0 | 52.6 | Edition 1 |
| 8 | **Georgia**<br>Candidate, process halted<br>Frozen or halted: scores reflect past progress | 15.0 | 28.0 | Edition 1 |
| 9 | **Bosnia & Herzegovina**<br>Candidate | 15.0 | 16.4 | Edition 1 |
| 10 | **Kosovo**<br>Applicant (potential candidate) | 5.0 | 26.7 | Edition 1 |

Scores from 0 to 100. Data as of 18 October 2026, identical to the EU Integration Tracker website.

# Country notes

Chapter counts and the latest developments for each country, ordered as in the ranking.

## Montenegro

**A 75.5 · B 61.2**

21 closed · 33 opened · 33 total

**Latest.** 16 Oct 2026: the final European Council conclusions dropped the goal of closing the remaining chapters by the end of this year and the pledge to finalise the accession treaty drafting as soon as possible. On 13 Oct chapters 17, 18 and 19 were provisionally closed, bringing the total to 21 of 33.

**Next step.** Close the remaining 12 chapters. The government aims to join in 2028. An accession roadmap is expected with the Commission's 2026 enlargement package on 4 November.

## Albania

**A 54.8 · B 47.7**

4 closed · 33 opened · 33 total

**Latest.** 13 Oct 2026: chapter 20 (enterprise and industrial policy) was provisionally closed, after chapters 25, 26 and 30 on 14 Jul 2026. Prime Minister Rama aims to close at least twice as many chapters by the end of 2026.

**Next step.** Close the other 29 chapters, including chapters 23 and 24. A roadmap is expected with the 2026 enlargement package on 4 November.

## Serbia

**A 43.5 · B 52.6**

2 closed · 22 opened · 34 total

**Latest.** July 2026: the Commission recommended opening Cluster 3, but EU ambassadors could not agree. Eight member states opposed it, citing the rule of law and weak alignment with EU foreign policy. No later Council decision was found as of 17 Oct 2026.

**Next step.** Unanimous Council decision to open Cluster 3, linked to progress on the rule of law and relations with Kosovo.

## Moldova

**A 43.2 · B 34.2**

0 closed · 24 opened · 33 total

**Latest.** 13 Oct 2026: Clusters 2 and 3 opened, after Cluster 1 on 15 Jun and Cluster 6 in July. Moldova's government aims to conclude talks by 2028 and join by 2030.

**Next step.** Open Clusters 4 and 5 (nine chapters), expected in December. Closing chapters depends on the Cluster 1 interim benchmark report. A roadmap is expected with the 2026 enlargement package on 4 November.

## Ukraine

**A 43.2 · B 32.9**

0 closed · 24 opened · 33 total

**Latest.** 13 Oct 2026: Clusters 2 and 3 opened after Hungary lifted its veto, following Ukraine's new minority-rights law passed on 12 October. Draft summit conclusions on 14 October dropped the phrase 'as soon as possible' on advancing the bid, according to diplomats.

**Next step.** Open Clusters 4 and 5 (nine chapters), expected in December. Closing chapters depends on the Cluster 1 interim benchmark report. A roadmap is expected with the 2026 enlargement package on 4 November.

## Türkiye

**A 38.3 · B 48.4**

1 closed · 16 opened · 33 total

**Latest.** Talks have been frozen since December 2016, and the Council reconfirms this every year. In August 2026 President Erdoğan said EU membership is no longer a priority.

**Next step.** None scheduled. Updating the customs union remains under discussion.

## North Macedonia

**A 25.0 · B 52.6**

0 closed · 0 opened · 33 total

**Latest.** 2 Oct 2026: in Skopje, Commission President von der Leyen said North Macedonia belongs in the EU and will get a roadmap once the process is unblocked. The next intergovernmental conference still depends on a constitutional amendment on the Bulgarian minority.

**Next step.** Constitutional amendment, then the first conference to open Cluster 1.

## Georgia

**A 15.0 · B 28.0**

No negotiating chapters yet

**Latest.** Accession has been on hold since mid-2024 over the foreign agents law. Georgia was left off the Commission's phased-accession plans, reported on 29 Sep 2026, and Tbilisi called this temporary. The government says talks are suspended until the end of 2028.

**Next step.** A Commission recommendation to open talks, considered unlikely under current conditions.

## Bosnia & Herzegovina

**A 15.0 · B 16.4**

No negotiating chapters yet

**Latest.** Elections on 4 Oct 2026 had a record-low 42% turnout and left nationalist and establishment parties in power. The negotiating framework is still not adopted: it awaits new laws on the State Court and the High Judicial and Prosecutorial Council, and a chief negotiator.

**Next step.** Meet those conditions so the Commission can propose the negotiating framework. Growth Plan funds are at risk if reforms miss the December deadline.

## Kosovo

**A 5.0 · B 26.7**

No negotiating chapters yet

**Latest.** The Council has not yet asked the Commission for an opinion on the application. Five member states do not recognise Kosovo: Cyprus, Greece, Romania, Slovakia and Spain.

**Next step.** Unanimous Council decision to request a Commission opinion.

# Methodology

The index combines three pillars. Every input comes from official EU sources and is published on the EU Integration Tracker website, so each score can be checked.

## 40%

### A. Formal stage

Where the country stands in the accession procedure, from the application to the end of negotiations. Updated after every accession conference.

Source: Council of the EU.

## 45%

### B. Level of preparation

Average Commission rating across the negotiating chapters, the economic criteria and public administration reform, rescaled from 1–5 to 0–100. Chapters 23 and 24 count double.

Source: European Commission annual reports.

## 15%

### C. Reform momentum

Progress recorded by the Commission over the last twelve months, from backsliding to very good progress, so that a country moving backwards is not rewarded for past progress.

Source: European Commission annual reports, from Edition 1.

### How pillar A is scored

| STEP | POINTS |
|---|---|
| Application submitted | 5 |
| Candidate status granted | 10 |
| Accession talks opened | 10 |
| Chapters opened | up to 25, in proportion |
| Chapters provisionally closed | up to 40, in proportion |
| Negotiations concluded and accession treaty signed | 10 |
| **Total** | **100** |

Shares use each country's own number of chapters: 34 for Serbia, 33 for the others.

### Rules and limits

- Frozen or halted processes are flagged. Their formal scores reflect steps taken in the past.
- Provisional closure of a chapter counts as closure, as reported by the Council, although it is not final until all chapters are agreed.
- The index measures progress in the procedure and in alignment with EU standards. It does not predict accession dates or judge whether a country should join.
- Preparation ratings for 2025 are taken from the European Commission reports as analysed by European Pravda and compiled on Wikipedia. From Edition 1 they will be read directly from the Commission reports.

### Release calendar

- **Edition 1, expected 4 November 2026:** full index with all three pillars, published after the Commission's enlargement package. The date depends on the package: if the Commission moves it, Edition 1 moves with it.
- **Quarterly updates from February 2027:** pillar A after accession conferences; pillars B and C fixed until the next Commission package.

**Sources.** Council of the EU, enlargement and country pages (consilium.europa.eu). European Commission, 2025 enlargement package country reports. European Pravda analysis of the 2025 reports, as compiled on Wikipedia. Accession conference press releases and reporting by European Western Balkans, The New Union Post and Brussels Times, October 2026.

EU Integration Tracker · Accession Progress Index · Preview edition, October 2026. Independent publication, not an official EU document.